



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Concordia Academy
School Website: <https://cawichita.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Classicality Audit: Candeo Schools (Peoria, AZ)

Website audited: <https://candeoschools.com>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

Candeo Schools presents a robust classical mission and language across its site: repeated commitments to "wisdom," "virtue," and "truth, goodness, and beauty"; identification with the Trivium; explicit statements about formation over information; and strong partnership-with-parents language. Curriculum pages explicitly ground the program in classical thought and the Trivium while using Core Knowledge for content. Pedagogy hints at wonder and rhetorical formation, but lacks explicit evidence of lower-school chanting/recitation and upper-grade Socratic seminar (the school appears K–8). Religious/theological integration and liturgical practices are not evident (as expected for a public charter). Faculty pages emphasize alignment to a classical philosophy and ongoing mentoring, but do not articulate a "portrait of a teacher" or the faculty as a "living curriculum."

Most classical criteria are met in Purpose/Goal, Curriculum, and Parents & Community. Evidence is thinner (though positive) in Pedagogy and Faculty, and the Religious/Metaphysical category shows transcendental moral realism without theological/ liturgical grounding. Result: **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** overall.

- Key textual signals:
- "Grow wisdom and virtue... through rigorous, knowledge-based schooling in the classical liberal arts" (mission/landing)
- "Grounded in classical thought and the Trivium... Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric" (Curriculum & Instruction)
- "Western Tradition... good, true, and beautiful" (Curriculum & Instruction)
- "Parents are the primary educators... partnership with parents" (About/Philosophy)

Note on framework: Keyword comparisons and category judgments are grounded in the Six Essential Elements lexicon of positive/negative indicators (e.g., truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, Trivium, great books, Socratic, scholé, chanting; and divergences like 21st-century skills, project-based learning dominance, etc.).

Element-by-Element Analysis (with mandatory keyword audit)

For each category below: - We list keywords/phrases found on the school site. - We map them to Positive/Negative indicators from the “Six Essential Elements” lexicon. - We estimate hit counts and coverage, then assign a category rating.

1) Religious and Metaphysical Foundations

Evidence from site: - Positive keyword matches in public materials: truth; goodness; beauty; virtue; wisdom; wonder; moral formation; Western Tradition; order/respect; “formation” (About, Mission/Philosophy; Curriculum; Parents) - Absent/low: theology, liturgy/chapel, worship, catechesis.

Lexicon alignment: - Positive indicators (moral realism/transcendentals): truth/goodness/beauty, virtue, wisdom, wonder (positive in the Religious/Metaphysical set) - Missing indicators: theological integration; liturgical/communal worship (also in the positive list)

Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: +10 (truth/goodness/beauty repeated; virtue; wisdom; wonder; moral formation; order/respect; Western Tradition) - Negative hits: -0 (no “values-neutral,” “moral relativism,” etc.) - Percent positive: 1.00 (pos/(pos+neg)) - Percent coverage (breadth of sub-elements within this category): 0.60 (strong on transcendental moral realism; little/no evidence of theology or liturgy)

Category rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Rationale: Strong transcendental moral realism; no evidence of theological grounding or liturgical practices typical of religious classical schools (consistent with public charter status).

2) School Purpose and Goal

Evidence from site: - “Grow wisdom and virtue for a life well lived...” (Mission) - “Education... a formative journey... to contemplate what is good, true, and beautiful” (Philosophy) - “Formation” emphasized repeatedly (About/Parents pages)

Lexicon alignment: - Positive: cultivation of wisdom/virtue; pursuit of truth, goodness, beauty; formation not (merely) information - Negative: none observed (no “college and career readiness/21st century skills” framing)

Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: +12 (wisdom, virtue, formation, truth/goodness/beauty, love of learning, flourishing) - Negative hits: -0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Percent coverage: 0.90 (all three sub-elements present strongly)

Category rating: CLASSICAL

3) School Curriculum

Evidence from site: - “Grounded in classical thought and the Trivium... Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric” (Curriculum & Instruction) - “Western civilization’s greatest works” (About/Philosophy) - “History” (not “social studies”); Great Books implied by “greatest works” - Uses Core Knowledge content (neutral to positive; content-rich coherence) - Hillsdale K-12 affiliation information linked (implies alignment) - Classical languages: French is listed; Latin not explicitly mentioned (Elementary section)

Lexicon alignment: - Positive: Trivium; great books/primary sources (implied by “greatest works”); history emphasis; unity of truth/wonder language present elsewhere - Negative: no evidence of STEM-first framing, social-studies-for-history, or project-based dominance

Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: +9 (Trivium; grammar/logic/rhetoric; great works; history; Western Tradition; wonder) - Negative hits: -0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Percent coverage: 0.75 (very strong on Trivium/history; great-books and Latin not named explicitly)

Category rating: CLASSICAL

4) School Pedagogy / Teaching Methods

Evidence from site: - Lower school: “daily time and space to... wonder, and think deeply” (restful/wonder) - Rhetorical formation: students “produce... beautiful works in writing and in speech” (rhetoric practice) - Not observed: Socratic seminar, explicit recitation/chanting, or explicit memory work language; no upper-school (HS) grades shown (appears K–8).

Lexicon alignment: - Positive: wonder/restful learning; rhetoric exercises in speech/writing - Missing: chanting/memorization, Socratic seminar/debate (acceptable if K–8 only, but still a signal to note)

Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: +3 (wonder/rest, rhetoric/speech) - Negative hits: -0 (no project-based/experiential-only emphasis) - Percent positive: 1.00 - Percent coverage: 0.40 (evidence is limited to wonder/rhetoric; other hallmark pedagogies not explicit)

Category rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Note: As a K–8, absence of HS Socratic seminars is not penalized; however, explicit chanting/recitation or stated mimetic/imitative practices would strengthen this category.

5) School Faculty

Evidence from site: - Hiring/Faculty culture: “love for the classical liberal arts,” alignment to philosophy and purpose, “mentoring,” “ongoing coaching, support” (Careers page) - Parents page: faculty who “care deeply and lead with purpose” (virtue modeling implied) - Not observed: a formal “portrait of a teacher,” explicit “teachers as models of virtue,” or the faculty described as the “living curriculum.”

Lexicon alignment: - Positive: mentorship/collegial development; virtue-oriented culture (implied) - Missing: explicit articulation of teachers as exemplars/living curriculum (positive indicator)

Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: +4 (mentoring/PD; alignment to classical philosophy; virtue-inflected faculty language) - Negative hits: -0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Percent coverage: 0.50 (some signals present; lacking explicit “teacher portrait”/exemplar language)

Category rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

6) School Parents and Community

Evidence from site: - “Parents are the primary educators... our school is a partner” (Philosophy) - “Statement of Educational Partnership with Parents” (explicit) - Parents page echoes partnership and shared mission (welcome letter)

Lexicon alignment: - Positive: parent partnership/coeducators; shared mission; school as partner with families (strong matches) - Missing: evidence of parent formation opportunities (book studies, seminars), open campus practices

Quantitative estimate: - Positive hits: +7 (parent partnership, coeducators, shared mission, explicit partnership statement) - Negative hits: -0 - Percent positive: 1.00 - Percent coverage: 0.90 (very strong partnership language; minor gaps in parent formation specifics)

Category rating: CLASSICAL

Aggregate Classification

- Religious/Metaphysical: Somewhat Classical
- Purpose/Goal: Classical
- Curriculum: Classical
- Pedagogy: Somewhat Classical
- Faculty: Somewhat Classical
- Parents/Community: Classical

Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Justification: Strong classical mission/purpose and curricular framing, very strong parent partnership. Pedagogical and faculty evidence is positive but thinner than typical mature classical schools; religious/theological/liturgical integration is not present (consistent with public chartering).

What would move the needle (from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL → CLASSICAL)

- Pedagogy (K–8):
 - Publish explicit practices for memory work: “chanting,” “recitation,” and “singing” in lower grades; name them as such to align with classical pedagogy language in the lexicon.
 - Name “Socratic discussion” (age-appropriate forms) and “narration, copywork/imitation (progymnas-mata)” where used, and show exemplar lesson snapshots.
 - Curriculum:
 - Publicly list a core reading/“Great Books” spine and primary sources by grade; consider explicit Latin (even exploratory) in K–8, or articulate the rationale if not offered.
 - Faculty:
 - Publish a “Portrait of a Teacher” and “Portrait of a Graduate”; state teachers as the “living curriculum” and “models of virtue,” and outline faculty classical formation (seminars, great books colloquia, mentoring).
 - Parents:
 - Add explicit parent formation opportunities (book clubs on classical education, talks on the Trivium, etc.) and highlight them on the Parents page.
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Evidence Appendix (select citations)

- Mission/Tagline and Classical framing: “RIGOROUS SCHOOLING IN THE CLASSICAL LIBERAL ARTS” (home), mission to “grow wisdom and virtue” (About)
 - Curriculum & Instruction: “Grounded in classical thought and the Trivium... Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric...”; Core Knowledge content; “good, true, and beautiful”
 - Elementary & Middle summaries: explicit “wonder” time; formation across disciplines; list of subjects (history, literature, etc.)
 - Parents partnership statement (explicit): “parents are the primary educators... partner with parents”
 - Careers/Faculty culture: alignment to classical liberal arts; mentoring and coaching emphasized
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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